Cooperation with China on Multipolarity

Historically, the Chinese had accepted the concept of multipolarity in the 1992 Party Congress meeting of the Communist Party of China (CPC) and found it very useful with the changing circumstances in international relations. It adopted multipolarity in its foreign policy strategy (Lo 2008). During the same time, China started rebuilding its ties with Russia due to the US unilateral decision-making process in world affairs. As part of integrating with the world, China explored new avenues and strategies in foreign policy objectives. As part of it, Jiang Zemin, the then Chinese president, officially incorporated the concept of a multipolar world (duojishijie) into Chinese foreign policy at the 14th Congress of the Communist Party of China in 1992. Later, it supported China's stance that a fair, just, and peaceful world is only possible through multipolarity (Lo 2008). By the time relations between China and Russian became routine, they had started cooperating again in world affairs with the positivity of both side leaders.

On April 23, 1997, Chinese President Jiang Zemin and Russian President Boris Yeltsin met in Moscow and signed the 'Joint Declaration on Multipolar World and the Formation of New International Orders' (UN General Assembly 1997). As part of it, Russia and China affirmed creating a new international order, in which multipolarity was the basic phenomenon. In this context, both countries observed profound changes at the end of twentieth-century international relations. The relations between major countries, and the former Cold War period adversaries, were also growing over the period (ibid.). In this process, diversity in political, economic, and cultural relations became the new norm, and a growing number of countries started to recognize the need for mutual respect, equality, and mutual benefit. And leaders acknowledged that all the world countries—whether small or large, strong or weak, rich or poor—are equal numbers of the international community (ibid.).

Again, on July 16, 2001, Chinese President Jiang Zemin went to Russia and signed the 'Treaty of Good-Neighbourliness and Friendly Cooperation between the People's Republic of China and the Russian Federation in Moscow. In this treaty, Russia and China underscored the importance of promoting and establishing a just and fair new world order based on universally recognized principles and norms of international law (Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Peoples Republic of China 2001). Furthermore, on November 4, 2006, during the Forum for Chinese and African cooperation, Chinese President Hu Jintao delivered a speech and said that the world is in a state of a complex condition. It is moving toward a multipolarity with the rise of the Global South countries in international relations. Further, he remarked that economic globalization had brought increasing interdependence among nations. It has led to an imbalanced development and widened the gap